AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

Section 18A Approved

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Vodacom Foundation × ASCO

Proposed ASCO Digital Access and Youth Empowerment Hubs

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: South Africa; select the province and implementation site only after ASCO confirms its operating footprint and Vodacom Foundation confirms an eligible location through the application process.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Vodacom Foundation** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Proposed ASCO Digital Access and Youth Empowerment Hubs**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Proposed ASCO Digital Access and Youth Empowerment Hubs in South Africa; select the province and implementation site only after ASCO confirms its operating footprint and Vodacom Foundation confirms an eligible location through the application process., benefiting Proposed: underserved learners and young people, with priority for youth facing digital-access barriers, reached through ASCO and eligible community/NPO or education partners; final numbers, age bands and selection criteria to be confirmed. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Vodacom Foundation's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Proposed ASCO Digital Access and Youth Empowerment Hubs

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
South Africa; select the province and implementation site only after ASCO confirms its operating footprint and Vodacom Foundation confirms an eligible location through the application process.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: underserved learners and young people, with priority for youth facing digital-access barriers, reached through ASCO and eligible community/NPO or education partners; final numbers, age bands and selection criteria to be confirmed.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: establish or equip 1 community-based digital learning hub, subject to Vodacom confirming in-kind support rather than cash funding.
- Proposed: provide digital-literacy and employability training to 100 young people over 12 months.
- Proposed: deliver at least 12 practical training sessions and track attendance, completion and pre/post digital-skills measures.
- Proposed: provide access to ICT devices/connectivity and curriculum or job-readiness resources for at least 100 beneficiaries, with the final device and data specification agreed with Vodacom.
- Proposed: submit quarterly monitoring reports covering reach, participation, safeguarding/referrals and documented outputs; these are targets, not completed results.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Vodacom Foundation?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- Vodacom Foundation's official South Africa page identifies two strategic pillars: quality education and gender empowerment.
- The Foundation says its strategic intent is to bridge digital gaps by assisting quintile 1-3 schools and registered NPOs with ICT equipment such as laptops and tablets; it may consider requests outside those specifications.
- The Foundation's application form accepts schools, ECD centres, NPOs and sustainability community groups, requires a province selection within South Africa, asks applicants to select Education, Gender Empowerment or Other, and includes a registered-NPO compliance question.
- The Foundation's official page states that it does not provide monetary funding and lists events, sports activities/apparel, religious organisations, workshops, scholarships, school excursions, publications and individuals among exclusions.
- Vodacom's ESG page describes digital inclusion through affordable connectivity, devices, free/zero-rated platforms, skills development, and targeted support for women and underserved communities; it says community work focuses on youth, underserved and marginalised people.
- Vodacom's 2025 official social-contract booklet describes Foundation support for underserved education communities through computer labs, digital tools, ICT coordinators, connectivity, psychosocial support and ECD resilience; it reports 39 Schools of Excellence and 39 ECD centres active by year-end 2025.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Submit through the official Vodacom Foundation application form: https://www.vodacom.com/vodacom-foundation-form.php. Vodacom's sponsorship guidance says Foundation-related requests should use the Foundation route. No direct Foundation email was identified on the official pages reviewed. ASCO's supplied contact is +27 76 757 5773 and https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/ for applicant-side follow-up.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The requested 100000 is monetary, while the Foundation's official page expressly says it does not provide monetary funding. Ask whether an in-kind ICT/connectivity/equipment contribution or another eligible support format could be considered instead; do not present the cash ask as eligible without confirmation.
- The Foundation's public pillars are Education and Gender Empowerment. Digital inclusion and youth development should therefore be positioned as means within an education/community-access proposal, not assumed to be standalone funding pillars.
- A specific province, delivery site, beneficiary baseline, implementation capacity, budget treatment and measurable results for ASCO were not provided or independently verified; confirm these before submission.
- The official application form asks for organisation type, province, request pillar, NPO registration number if applicable, physical address and contact details. Eligibility and approval remain at Vodacom Foundation's discretion.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- Do not claim Vodacom funding, partnership, endorsement, completed outcomes or matched contribution until documented in writing.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Vodacom Foundation** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Executive Director
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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.vodacom.com/vodacom-foundation.php
2. https://www.vodacom.com/vodacom-foundation-form.php
3. https://www.vodacom.com/empowering-people.php
4. https://www.vodacom.com/pdf/social-report/vodacom-social-report-2021.pdf
5. https://www.vodacom.co.za/sites/vodacomcoza/files/media/documents/pdf/vodacomasocialcontractwithourstakeholders2025.pdf
6. https://now.vodacom.co.za/do-it-yourself/looking-for-sponsorship-from-vodacom/
7. https://now.vodacom.co.za/brand-with-a-purpose/a-purpose-led-organisation-making-a-lasting-impact/

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.